society. Integrated with commercialization of the Internet, personal computers and electronic payment systems together made E-Commerce flourish.

The growth of E-Commerce is also related to the socio-technological changes. The more, the medium becomes deep-rooted, the more, are the users drawn towards it. Increase of users, increases the markets. As the markets expand, more business organizations are attracted. The more businesses accumulate it create competition. The competition leads to innovation; innovation in turn drives the development of technology; technology facilitates E-Commerce's growth. See Figure 15.4



In August 11, 1994 by noon of the day, Phil Brandenberger of Philadelphia (U.S.A), bought a music CD (Sting's "Ten Summoners' Tales") from Kohn of Nashua (U.S.A) and paid $12.48 plus shipping charges using his credit card through online. This is marked as the first true E-Commerce transaction.

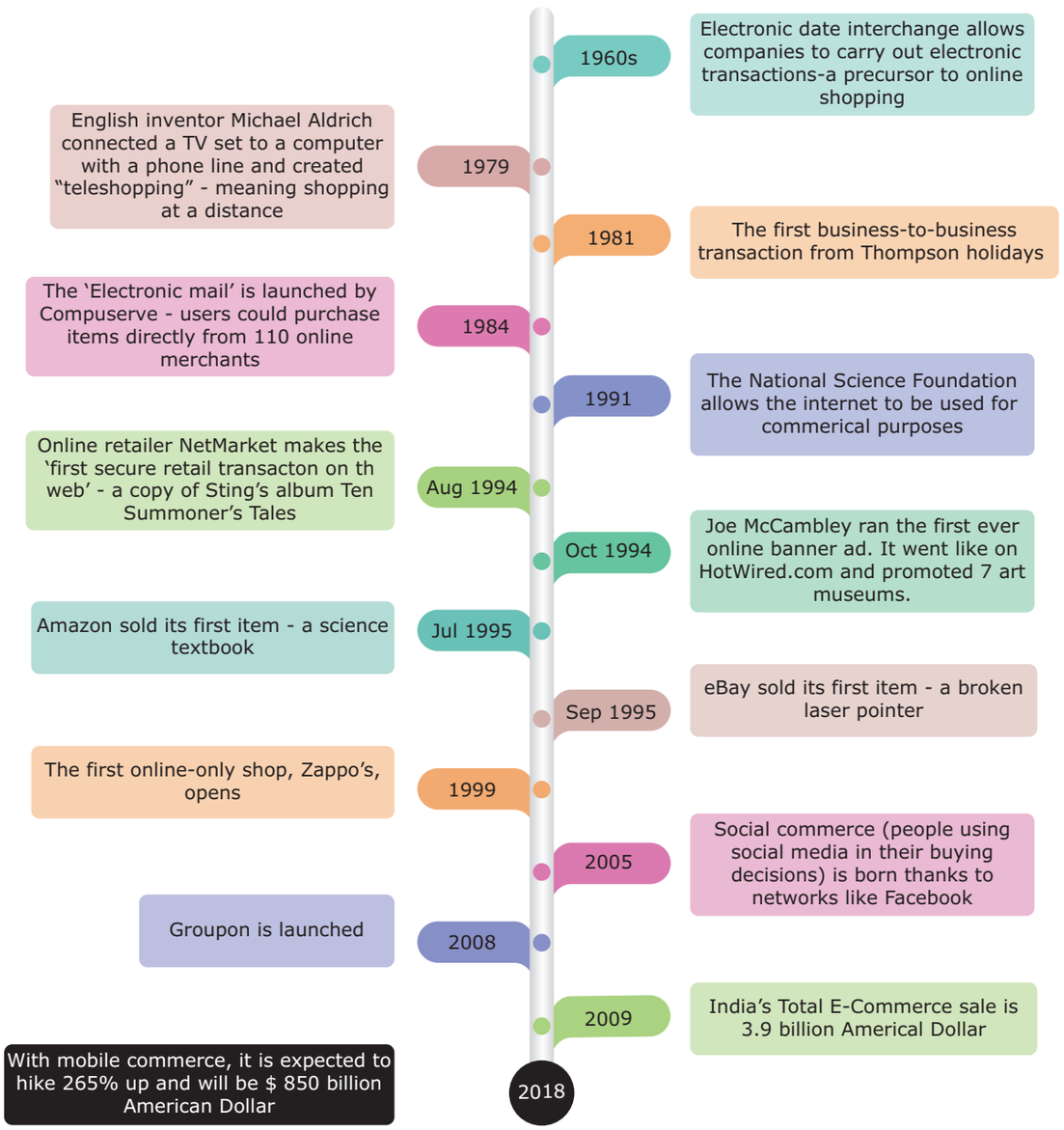


Figure 15.4 Timeline describing various events in E-Commerce

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